Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-16

Linux

[$] Vendor hooks in the Android kernel

Source: LWN.net

> Since Android's inception, the kernels it has used have diverged significantly from the mainline. While many of those differences have been resolved over time, and the move to the generic kernel image has helped to bring Android closer, current devices still carry a lot of out-of-tree changes. The p...

KDE releases documentary

Source: LWN.net

> As part of KDE's 30th anniversary celebration , the project has released The KDE Documentary — A Story of Free Software Underdogs (YouTube video): The story starts in 1996, when Matthias Ettrich, a student at the University of Tübingen, posted to a Usenet group asking for programmers to help build...

Ubuntu 26.10 released

Source: LWN.net

> Canonical has announced the release of Ubuntu 26.10 ("Stonking Stingray"): Ubuntu 26.10 advances enterprise security features, completes the rollout of the Rust-based uutils coreutils , and strengthens integrations for user authentication using Microsoft Entra ID. [...] Ubuntu 26.10 also ships with...

Security updates for Thursday

Source: LWN.net

> Security updates have been issued by AlmaLinux (environment-modules, flatpak-builder, kernel, kernel-rt, librabbitmq, libreoffice, libsoup, mod_auth_openidc:2.3, nodejs:22, nodejs:24, OpenEXR, opentelemetry-collector, pki-core:10.6, postgresql:12, python-tornado, python36:3.6, ruby:3.3, tftp, and xo...

Seven stable kernels for Thursday with fix for critical vulnerability

Source: LWN.net

> Greg Kroah-Hartman has announced the release of the 7.2.11 , 6.18.57 , 6.12.113 , 6.6.159 , 6.1.190 , 5.15.223 , and 5.10.272 stable kernels. This series

> includes, among other things, a fix for a critical vulnerability (CVE-2026-99999). The flaw in skb_checksum_help() would allow an IPv4 packet wi...

Friday Five — October 16, 2026 | Red Hat

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Open Source Security Signals | Q3 2026Red Hat's inaugural Open Source Security Signals report examines how the ecosystem identifies meaningful risk, remediates vulnerabilities, and delivers reusable fixes. Drawing on Lightwell data, it models how one shared remediation—such as for JAXB—can reduce du...

Red Hat Summit 2027 call for proposals is now open

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Red Hat is headed back to Boston for our annual keystone event – Red Hat Summit! We’re building an agenda of technical and non-technical content for our experienced audience and looking for our community of experts — customers, partners, and associates — to share their knowledge and experiences. The...

Open Source Security Signals | Q3 2026

Source: Red Hat Blog

> Vulnerabilities are easy to count. Meaningful risk is harder to measure.Open source has become the foundation of modern software because it works. Shared innovation, transparent development, global communities, and broad reuse let software advance at a scale no single organization could achieve alon...

Security

China-Linked Hackers Exploited BeyondTrust Zero-Day to Take Over Remote Support Servers

Source: The Hacker News

> The China-nexus cyber espionage group tracked as Armory Castle (previously UNC5221 or Warp Panda) exploited a newly disclosed security flaw in BeyondTrust Remote Support (formerly Bomgar) as a zero-day in late August 2026. The vulnerability, tracked as CVE-2026-102764 (CVSS score: 9.3), is a case of...

CERT-In Warns AI Agents Accessed Sensitive Data at Indian Organizations During Testing

Source: The Hacker News

> AI agents being tested online reached the live systems of Indian organizations and read business records, including personal data and confidential material, CERT-In

> said in an advisory on October 15. The agents went beyond their assigned tasks, and none of the organizations detected the unauthorized...

PEERSTITCH Malware Deployed via FortiOS Flaw Bypasses Checks on Tagged VPN Sessions

Source: The Hacker News

> A suspected advanced threat actor has been observed exploiting a security flaw in Fortinet FortiOS to deliver a previously unreported memory-resident ARM64 malware known as PEERSTITCH. The attack involves the exploitation of CVE-2025-61624 (CVSS score: 5.4), a path traversal flaw in the command line...

Critical PwnEscape Linux Kernel Vulnerability Lets Guest VMs Read Host Memory

Source: The Hacker News

> A newly disclosed critical flaw in the Linux kernel allows code inside a virtual machine to read memory on the host computer it runs on. A researcher demonstrated the leak against Vercel's live cloud sandboxes, and Vercel confirmed it. The flaw, now tracked as CVE-2026-99999 and nicknamed PwnEscape,...

ThreatsDay: Adobe RCE, DNS Wallet Theft, NVIDIA Container Escape, Self-Healing Backdoor + 23 More

Source: The Hacker News

> Someone built a tool to steal data, then decided it should scare the victim for fun. Yes, that’s an actual feature. And somehow, it fits right in with this week's security stories. The rest gets interesting in different ways. A small permission can lead to a big theft. A trusted login can hide the w...

Citizen Lab Traces Zero-Click Candiru Spyware Infections at Al Jazeera to Targeted Online Ads

Source: The Hacker News

> Candiru, an Israeli maker of spyware sold to governments, infected devices at the news network Al Jazeera through ordinary online ads, in attacks that needed no click or other action from the user, researchers at the Citizen Lab said Thursday. The hidden attack code ran the moment an ad loaded on th...

Silent Lynx Exploits WinRAR Flaw to Deploy Reverse Shell in CIS Government Attacks

Source: The Hacker News

> The threat actor known as Silent Lynx has been attributed to a fresh set of attacks targeting government organizations across the Commonwealth of Independent

> States (CIS). The activity, observed from June 2025 through August 2026, involves four different infection chains that make use of macro-enabl...

Help TDS Linked to Hotejka as 20,000+ Cloudflare Pages Domains Host Tech Support Scams

Source: The Hacker News

> A long-running Traffic Distribution System (TDS) known as Help TDS to a Russian-language affiliate program called Hotejka, which appears to be a rebrand of a traffic monetization operation dubbed ROI777. Help TDS is assessed to be active since at least 2017, offering PHP code templates to partners a...

NGINX Fixes 5 Flaws, Including Possible RCE and a TLS Bug That May Skip Client-Cert Checks

Source: The Hacker News

> NGINX released versions 1.30.6 and 1.31.7 on October 14 to fix five vulnerabilities, one of them present in every release since May 2005. There are three memory bugs that F5, the company behind NGINX, says could crash a worker process or possibly let an attacker run code, and each requires a specifi...

Next.js Ships Out-of-Band Patch for Two Critical RCE Flaws in Caching and SVG Processing

Source: The Hacker News

> Next.js released an out-of-band security update on October 14 that fixes two critical flaws allowing unauthenticated remote code execution, along with a high-severity denial-of-service flaw. One code-execution flaw is in React Server Components, and the other in librsvg, the open-source library Next...

Drupal Patches Critical Field UI Flaw With Unauthenticated RCE Path via Contributed Modules

Source: The Hacker News

> Drupal core has a critical flaw in its Field UI module that could let an attacker run code on the site's server, and fixes were shipped on October 14 in Drupal 11.4.10, 11.3.19, and 10.6.19. An attacker cannot reach the flaw through core alone, the Drupal Security Team said in its advisory. Several...

Fake AI Attacks Spread Across US Companies: How MSSPs Can Stop Incidents Early

Source: The Hacker News

> Attackers are impersonating popular AI products to distribute malware, steal browser sessions, and compromise business accounts. ANY.RUN linked 1,258

> public sandbox analyses to fake AI campaigns between April and October of 2026. The campaigns also increase operational pressure on MSSPs serving US b...

Why AI Confidence Is Not Validation

Source: The Hacker News

> AI is already part of digital forensics and incident response work, with or without a policy in place to govern it. The issue is that these tools are growing more confident in their own output faster than practitioners are developing reliable ways to verify it. Without governance models and validati...

India Mandates Registered Caller Name Display on 4G and Newer Networks From November 1

Source: The Hacker News

> The Indian government has directed telecom service providers (TSPs) in the country to mandatorily display callers' registered names along with their numbers for incoming calls starting November 1, 2026, in an effort to help people identify calls from unknown numbers and tackle spam or fraudulent cal...